Battle For Gratis LXIX

'They may be Savages, but we have our Axes. We also have von Hippels and Madsens, but they are of a lesser value.'

- Lord Inquisitor Harman, from the bridge of the Budgies capital ship Quality Champion

RETURN TO GRATUS LXIX

Deep in the heart of the Gamma-Bridge, the jovian Gratus and the denizens of its countless moons have enjoyed relative obscurity for generations. War, warp storms, and more pressing matters elsewhere have kept the system mostly free of enemies (and coincidentally, Imperial oversight.) However, a Chaos incursion on an archaeological supercomplex has revealed a vast deposit of archeotech scattered across one of the planet's moons. Within days, news of the discovery had spread far beyond the sector and the floodgates were opened. While Traitors and Xenos pour into the system, the might of the Imperium flocks to defend their newly found resources.

Their target is Gratus LXIX (Cor Gratus). Formerly peaceful and prosperous, this glittering Imperial metropolis is now steeling itself for war. The lush capital world was the nerve center for colonization and industrialization efforts in the cluster. Though the system maintains a respectable military force, the majority of the Militarum's muscle resides at Gratus X – cut off and isolated by the Chaos invasion. The greater Imperium has answered Gratus' call for aid, though there are whispers that planetary administrators themselves fear reprisal from their would-be saviors. Traditional loyalties break down quickly and alliances of convenience form as the various warlords learn the extent of the bounty at stake.

OVERVIEW

Return to Gratus LXIX is a map campaign that features epic battles waged at the front lines and covert special operations conducted deep within enemy territory. As such, the campaign will be fought using both games of Warhammer 40,000 and Kill Team, with games from each system affecting the campaign in unique ways. Players can mix and match game systems each week or stick to just one system for the duration.

The campaign will chronicle the war for control of the moon's surface, as well as the factions' efforts to secure unique archeotech relics. The results of individual battles and operations will be reflected on the **Map** which will be maintained by the **Arbitrator**.

Winning a game will allow your faction to conduct actions on the Map. The type of game played determines what sort of action can be taken.

- Victories in Warhammer 40,000 will earn **Military Actions,** which let factions battle for control of territory.
- Victories in Kill Team earn SpecOps Cards, which let factions affect the buildings within territory, recover archeotech, or enhance military actions.

GOAL

The goal of the campaign is nothing short of **Supreme Victory**. Progress is measured through **Supreme Victory Points (SVP).** SVP are earned by controlling buildings, recovering Crusade Relics, and securing Vital Intel.

SVP are awarded as follows:

- Each building is worth 1 SVP, Hive Cities are worth 3 SVP.
- Crusade Relics are worth SVP depending on their category:
  - Artificer Relics are 1 SVP.
  - Antiquity Relics are 2 SVP.
  - Legendary Relics are 3 SVP.
- Vital Intels SpecOps Cards are worth 1 SVP.

The winner of the campaign will be the player who had the most fun. The runner-up will be the team who secures the most SVP.

TEAMS

Three precarious alliances have formed, each hoping to remove their enemies from the moon. What remains of the alliance was the dust has settled is another matter. Each team member is allowed one Crusade force, generated using standard Crusade rules, and one Kill Team, generated using standard SpecOps narrative play rules. Your Crusade force and Kill Team can be of any faction, but we encourage you to make them narratively cohesive. If you would like to change your Crusade force or Kill Team during the campaign, please speak to the Arbitrator about how that can be accommodated.

Each Team must nominate a **Grand Marshall** who will act as their representative. While teams should make decisions together, in instances where that is not possible the Grand Marshall can make an executive decision to ensure the campaign runs smoothly. The Grand Marshall should be able to commit to participating during the entirety of the event, as they will be the primary liaison between their team and the arbitrator.

- There are 3 teams. Each team member can have 1 Crusade force and one Kill Team.
- Each team selects someone to be their **Grand Marshall.** The Grand Marshall has final decision power for the team.

THE MAP

The main focus of the Gratus LXIX campaign is the map. It reflects how well teams are performing and provides an extra layer of strategic depth. The map is divided into hexagonal territories, or **hexes**, which make up the basic units of the map. Control of these hexes will change depending on the outcomes of battles fought during campaign rounds.

Each team will begin the campaign in control of a portion of the map. This is their **territory.** As the campaign progresses, they will wage war to expand their territory, secure valuable structures, and encircle their opponents' positions.

ISOLATED TERRITORY

If at some point a controlled hex is no longer contiguous with the controlling team's Headquarters, that hex becomes **isolated.** Buildings in isolated territory:

- Cannot be the origin of Offensive Actions.
- Cannot be the target of certain SpecOps cards.
- Are not worth SVP at the end of the campaign.

Isolated buildings still provide their listed abilities, provided they have sufficient power.

THE CAMPAIGN ROUND

The campaign will run over the course of six weeks. Each week represents one **Campaign Round.** A campaign round is divided into two phases, the **Operations Phase** and the **Strategic Phase.**

1. THE OPERATIONS PHASE [MONDAY-SATURDAY]

During the Operations Phase, participants find opponents and play games to earn rewards to be used in the Strategic Phase.

The Operations Phase lasts Monday to Saturday. Games played on a Sunday count towards the next week's results.

Each player can play count Crusade game and as many Kill Team games as they wish. The results of these games should be submitted to the Arbitrator and the Grand Marshall of the teams involved.

The winner of a Crusade game will earn a Military Action for their team. The winner of a Kill team game will earn a SpecOps Card to be used immediately or saved for future use.

SCHEDULING GAMES

The campaign rules are designed to facilitate easy matchmaking. Players do not need to know the results of the Strategic Phase to schedule games – players are encouraged to schedule games well in advance without worrying about the effects on their team's strategy. Players can also choose an opponent from any opposing team.

Military and SpecOps cards can be used against any opposing team, regardless of opponents.

Players should avoid playing against their own team when possible. Intra-team play is permitted if a player is unable to schedule a game otherwise. To avoid intra-team play, the Arbitrator may ask players to volunteer to swap opponents. If you are having trouble finding a game, reach out to the Arbitrator. One of the Arbitrator's jobs is to make sure everyone is able to participate!

WARHAMMER 40,000 CRUSADE GAMES

Crusade games will be played using standard Crusade missions or the Leviathan Mission Cards. Determine the mission parameters as normal. There is no set point size, opponents can agree on any point limit that is within the supply cap of both players.

For each Crusade victory, the winning team earns one **Military Action** which can be used to make one **Offensive Action** or one **Defensive Action** in the subsequent Strategy Phase.

- Crusade games are played using standard Crusade rules or using the Leviathan Mission Deck.
- Victories in Crusade games award Military Actions.

KILL TEAM SPECOPS GAMES

Kill Team will be played using the SpecOps Narrative Play rules. During the Determine the Mission step, the two players roll off and the winner picks the mission and becomes the attacker. Missions are then played out as normal. The winner of the game will earn a SpecOps Card based on which mission they won. If there are multiple options for a card, the winner can choose one card. If you would like to play a mission not on the list and would make narrative sense, please reach out to the Arbitrator.

SpecOps Cards are held in a team's hand until they are played. This means a faction may wait multiple weeks before using a particular card. However, each particular SpecOps Card may only be played once per week.

SABOTAGE

Mission: **[MASTER THE TERMINALS]**

Use before the Strategic Phase begins. Choose one of the below options:

- Destroy a target Power Station, Command Bastion, Shield Generator, or Manufactorum.
- Disable a Spaceport for one turn.

RECOVERED STC

Mission: **[LOOT AND SALVAGE] [MASTERTHE TERMINALS]**

Use in the Strategic Phase when using building abilities. Construct a Power Station, Command Bastion, Shield Generator, or Manufactorum in one friendly hex. A new building can be built in a hex that already contains a building, but the new building will replace the existent one. Buildings are placed before Military Actions are resolved. Cannot be used in Isolated Territories.

SUPERIOR LOGISTICS

Mission: **[LOOT AND SALVAGE] [SIEZE GROUND]**

Use in the Strategic Phase. Select one friendly hex that is not isolated. That hex can be used as the point of origin of one additional Offensive Action.

ACQUIRE ARTIFACT

Mission: **[SECURE ARCHEOTECH]**

Use during the Strategic Phase. Select one Crusade Relic from the Leviathan Crusade rules which can be used by a member of your team. That player adds the chosen Crusade Relic to an eligible character on their Crusade roster. If that Crusade Relic has already been claimed, it is removed from the current owner's roster and added to the new owner's roster. If multiple teams play this card in the same week and target the same Crusade Relic, the effects cancel out and the Crusade Relic does not change hands.

VITAL INTEL

Mission: **[DUEL OF WITS] [DOMINATION]**

Use during the Strategic Phase. Score one Supreme Victory Point for your team.

FEINT ATTACK [REACTION]

Mission: **[CONSECRATION] [ESCALATING HOSTILITIES]**

Use after Military Actions are revealed but before they are resolved. Change the target of a friendly Offensive Action.

The origin of the Offensive Action cannot be changed. Cannot be used on Isolated Territory.

STOLEN PLANS [REACTION]

Mission: [AWAKEN THE DATA-SPIRITS] [SIEZE GROUND]

Use after Military Actions are revealed but before they are resolved. Count as having an extra Defensive Action in chosen friendly hex. Cannot be used on Isolated Territory.

- Kill Team games are played using SpecOps Narrative Play rules.
- SpecOps cards can be held indefinitely, but only one of each card can be played per campaign week.

2. THE STRATEGIC PHASE [SUNDAY]

In the Strategic Phase, teams conduct Military Actions and use SpecOps Cards earned from the games played in the Operations Phase.

At the end of each campaign round there is a Strategic Phase. Each team's Grand Marshal, with the help of their team, will devise a Secret Plan about how to capitalize on their successes on the battlefield. The plan will entail the use of Military Actions, building abilities, and SpecOp Cards and must be submitted to the Arbitrator. For each Crusade victory, the winning team earns one Military Action which can be used to make one **Offensive Action** or one **Defensive Action**. The results are revealed after all teams have submitted their Secret Plan and are executed simultaneously.

- Military Actions can be used to perform either an Offensive Action or a Defensive Action.
- Results of Military Actions are revealed simultaneously.

The following sequence is used resolving the Strategic Phase:

1. DESTROY BUILDINGS

Buildings are destroyed using the [SABOTAGE] SpecOps Card.

2. REVEAL THE SECRET PLAN

Grand Marshals reveal their Secret Plan to the Arbitrator.

- [RECOVERED STC] [SUPERIOR LOGISTICS] [ACQUIRE ARTIFACTS] and [VITAL INTEL] SpecOps Cards are executed.
- Building abilities are used.
- Military Actions are declared.

3. SECRET PLANS OVERLAID TO MAP

The Arbitrator reveals the Secret Plans by placing them on the map.

4. GRAND MARSHALS DECLARE REACTIONS

The Grand Marshals declare use of the [FEINT] and [STOLEN PLANS] SpecOps Cards.

5. FINAL RESULT

The Arbitrator reveals the final results for the week.

Designer Commentary: Teams are allowed to discuss their plans with other teams and coordinate attacks. Just be warned, these negotiations are in no way binding and there is no way to know if your "allies" kept their word until the secret plans are revealed. This system might be familiar if you've played Diplomacy.

CONSTRUCTING BUILDINGS

Manufactorums and the [RECOVERED STC] SpecOps Card can be used to build new buildings. As part of the Secret Plan, note down which buildings will be built in which hex. New buildings are added before resolving Offensive and Defensive Actions and they take effect immediately, provided they have power. Manufactorums do not produce new buildings in the turn in which they are built.

OFFENSIVE ACTIONS

To make an Offensive Action, the Grand Marshal selects one friendly hex as the attack's origin and one adjacent hex as the attack's target. Each hex can only be the origin of a single attack, however multiple attacks can target the same hex. The total number of a team's attacks targeting a given hex is the Attack Score against that hex. Offensive Actions cannot originate from Isolated Territories.

DEFENSIVE ACTIONS

To make a Defensive Action, the Grand Marshal selects one friendly hex to be defended. Any number of Defensive Actions can be declared for a given hex. The total number of Defensive Actions in a given hex is that team's Defensive Score.

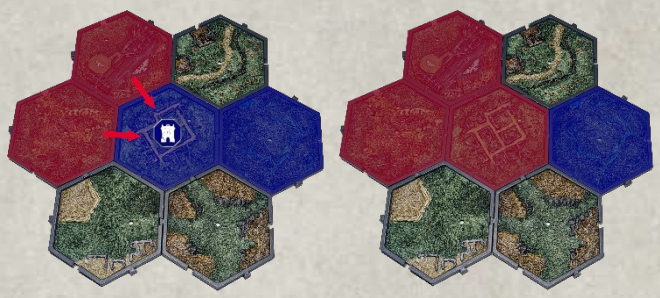
REACTION CARDS

The [STOLEN PLANS] and [FEINT ATTACK] SpecOps Cards are played after the Secret Plans are revealed. Marshals that intend to use these cards must submit a second Secret Plan to the Arbitrator after the initial plans have been revealed. Then all Reaction Cards are resolved simultaneously.

RESOLVING MILITARY ACTIONS

If an Offensive Action targets a hex and its Attack Score is greater than the Defensive Score of the hex, then the attacking team takes control of that hex.

The red team has declared two Offensive Actions against the center hex. The blue team has declared a single Defensive Action in the center hex. Since the red team's Attack Score is 2 and the blue team's Defensive Score is only 1, the red team takes the hex.



If an Offensive Action would capture the origin point of an opponent's Offensive Action, then the opponent's Offensive Action(s) become Defensive.

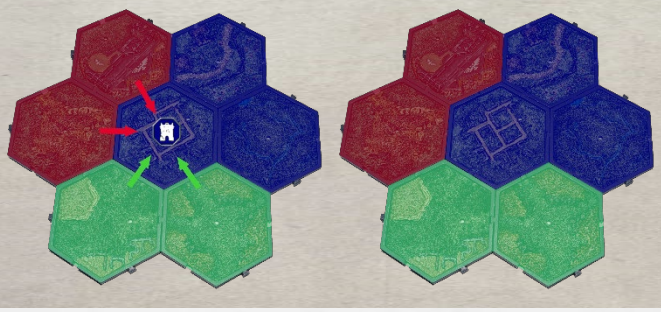
The red team has declared an Offensive Action against the center hex. The blue team has declared an Offensive Action from the center hex. The red team's Offensive Action is attacking the origin of the blue team's attack, so its Offensive Action instead becomes a Defensive Action. As such, both the Attack and Defensive Score equal 1 and cancel out.

Offensive Actions from hexes that are not themselves the target of an Offensive Action take precedence over those that are the target of an Offensive Action.

The red team has declared two Offensive Actions against the center hex. The blue team has declared a Defensive Action in the center hex and an Offensive Action from the upper right hex against the upper left, targeting the origin of one of red team's Offensive Actions. The Offensive Action by the blue will turn the red team's Offensive Action into a Defensive Action. This will cause both remaining Offensive Actions to tie, causing no territory to change hands.

If two separate teams make an Offensive Action against the same hex, then the team with the higher Attack Score takes the hex. In the event of a tie, no one takes the hex.

Red team and green team have both declared two Offensive Actions against the blue team, who have only declared a single Defensive Action in the center hex. Because both red and green have an Attack Score of 2, no territory is taken.



BUILDINGS

Buildings are special sites that alter the options available to a team. Each hex can only support one building and all buildings require power, which is provided by Power Stations.

EMPTY TERRITORIES

Do nothing, it's free real estate. (0 SVP)

HEADQUARTERS

The team's base of operations. Each team begins with a Headquarters, which cannot be disabled or destroyed. Teams cannot build additional Headquarters. Provides the benefit of a Power Station and a Shield Generator. (3 SVP)

POWER STATIONS

If a hex contains a Power Station, friendly buildings in adjacent hexes count as powered. (1 SVP)

COMMAND BASTIONS

If a hex contains a powered Command Bastion, two Offensive Actions can use this hex as their origin. (1 SVP)

SHIELD GENERATORS

If a hex contains a powered Shield Generator, it counts as having one free Defensive Action in each Strategic Phase. (1 SVP)

MANUFACTORUM

If a hex contains a powered Manufactorum, a team may construct one new building in a friendly hex. The new building can be built in a hex that already contains a building, with the new building replacing the old. New buildings can only be built in hexes that are connected by contiguously controlled hexes with the Manufactorum hex. A Manufactorum cannot create a building in the turn it itself is built. (1 SVP)

SPACEPORTS

If a hex contains a Spaceport, that hex can be used as the point of origin for a single attack to anywhere on the map. Spaceports cannot be built and if a Spaceport is the target of the **[SABOTAGE]** SpecOps Card, then it is only disabled for one turn. Spaceports provide the benefit of a Power Station. (1 SVP)

HIVE CITIES

If a hex contains a Hive City, it provides the benefits of a Command Bastion, Shield Generator, Power Station, and Manufactorum. Hive Cities cannot be built, disabled, or destroyed. (3 SVP)

Hexes containing Hive Cities behave differently than other hexes. The Hive City functions as a "hex within a hex," where the Hive City hex must be conquered twice to fully gain the benefits. The outer "hex" is the Outskirts, the inner area is the Spire. All building effects come from the Spire. The Outskirts must be captured first and provides no benefit until the Spire is captured. This is done in the same manner as capturing any other hex. Once the Outskirts are controlled, a team may capture the Spire in a subsequent turn.

If a team controls the Hive City and another team has a successful Offensive Action against the Hive City's hex, then the attacking team takes control of the Outskirts. If this happens, the Hive City is considered isolated.

CRUSADE RELICS

Crusade Relics represent valuable archeotech and are one of the main goals for achieving supreme victory. The only Crusade Relics available are those listed in the Leviathan Crusade rules (i.e. no codex relics are allowed once those become available). Each Relic is unique in the campaign and as such only one of each can be found. Crusade Relics can only be found using the **[RECOVER RELIC]** SpecOps Card or as the result of a Crusade mission victory bonus. If a Relic is already in the possession of another team, **[RECOVER RELIC]** can be used to steal that Relic instead. **[RECOVER RELIC]** can also be used to protect a Relic from being stolen. If multiple teams use **[RECOVER RELIC]** on the same Relic, then the Relic does not change possession.

Crusade Relics are worth SVP depending on their category.

- Each Crusade Relic is one of a kind and only Relics from Leviathan are allowed.
- The **[RECOVER RELIC]** SpecOps Card can be used to obtain a new Relic or steal one from another team. **[RECOVER RELIC]** and Crusade mission victory bonuses are the only means of obtaining Crusade Relics.

THE MAELSTROM OF WAR

War is not like moving pieces across a board. The winds of fate are fickle and not even the best generals are able to account for every variable. Throughout the course of the campaign, the Arbitrator may introduce new rules or modify existing rules. The goal is to keep strategists on their toes and to take advantage of the added freedom of the narrative play style. In some instances, this may benefit some more than others, or give a struggling team a bit of a boost to help keep everyone engaged. While we like to keep everything as fair as possible, sometimes a little spectacle is more enjoyable.